JUNIOR SCHOOL LEARNING HUB

GRADE 8 ENGLISH

DETAILED TEACHING NOTES • FULL YEAR • 2027

School: _____ **Teacher:** _____

TSC No.: _____ **Learning Area:** English

Curriculum planning basis: Grade 8 English learning themes and skill areas used in the accompanying 2027 scheme. These school-neutral notes support teaching and learning; they are not an official KICD publication. Teachers should consult the current KICD Grade 8 English Curriculum Design, approved learner's book and selected class reader for exact scope and text selection.

How to use these notes

• Use the notes alongside the scheme of work and lesson plans. The theme provides a context for developing language skills; it is not a substitute for the prescribed skill focus.

• Select age-appropriate print, oral, audio and digital texts. Respect copyright and acknowledge sources.

• Use the school-selected KICD-approved class reader; no single play or anthology is assumed here.

• Give learners opportunities to listen, speak, read, analyse language, write, revise and present work.

• Adapt tasks for learners who need additional support and provide extension activities for learners ready for greater challenge.

Human Rights

Human rights are basic entitlements and freedoms that belong to every person. They are connected with human dignity, equality, fairness and responsibility.

Key knowledge and language

• Rights may include the right to life, education, privacy, expression, safety and fair treatment. Rights are accompanied by responsibilities to respect the rights of others.

• Human rights language should be precise and respectful. Avoid stereotypes and distinguish a right from a privilege or favour.

• Useful vocabulary: dignity, equality, discrimination, freedom, responsibility, justice, inclusion, protection and respect.

• Listening and speaking: discuss a rights-related situation, listen without interrupting and express a view politely. Reading: identify the main claim and supporting reasons in an informational text. Writing: compose a coherent paragraph or letter advocating respectful treatment.

Suggested learning activity

Read a short age-appropriate text about access to education. Identify the right discussed, evidence in the text and responsibilities of learners and institutions.

Check your understanding

1. Explain the meaning of human rights.

2. Give examples of rights and related responsibilities.

3. Write a paragraph explaining why dignity and equality matter.

4. Use polite expressions to disagree with an unfair statement.

Scientific Innovations

Scientific innovation involves applying knowledge, creativity and investigation to develop new ideas, products or processes or improve existing ones.

Key knowledge and language

• Innovations may address health, communication, transport, agriculture, energy and education. They can bring benefits but may also raise questions about safety, access, privacy and environmental effects.

• Distinguish an invention (a new device or process) from an innovation (a new or improved way of applying an idea).

• Useful vocabulary: discovery, invention, innovation, experiment, evidence, prototype, efficiency, technology and impact.

• Language work: explain a process in sequence; compare advantages and limitations; use cause-and-effect connectors such as because, therefore, consequently and however.

Suggested learning activity

Choose a familiar innovation such as a water filter or mobile learning tool. Read a short information text, extract its purpose and explain one benefit and one possible limitation.

Check your understanding

1. Define scientific innovation.

2. Distinguish an invention from an innovation.

3. Give examples of innovations and explain their effects.

4. Prepare a short oral presentation about an innovation.

Pollution

Pollution is the introduction of harmful substances or forms of energy into the environment. It can affect air, water, land and living organisms.

Key knowledge and language

• Air pollution may result from smoke, dust and harmful gases. Water pollution may arise from sewage, chemicals, oil and poorly managed waste. Land pollution includes littering and unsafe disposal of solid waste. Noise pollution involves unwanted or harmful sound.

• Effects may include illness, damage to habitats, contaminated water, reduced soil quality and disturbance to wildlife.

• Prevention includes reducing waste, reusing and recycling materials, safe disposal, cleaner energy, tree planting and community education.

• Useful language includes cause, effect, consequence, solution, prevent, reduce, reuse, recycle and conserve. Use linking expressions to build explanations.

Suggested learning activity

Study a local environmental poster or report. Identify the pollution problem, its causes, effects and proposed solutions. Write a short persuasive paragraph encouraging responsible action.

Check your understanding

1. Identify different forms of pollution.

2. Explain causes and effects of pollution.

3. Suggest practical ways of preventing or reducing pollution.

4. Prepare a clear oral report on an environmental issue.

Consumer Roles and Responsibilities

A consumer is a person who uses goods or services. Responsible consumers make informed choices and understand that their decisions affect households, businesses and the environment.

Key knowledge and language

• Consumers compare quality, price, quantity, safety, usefulness and durability before purchasing.

• Responsibilities include checking labels, reading instructions, keeping receipts, using products safely, avoiding waste and reporting unsafe or misleading goods.

• Advertising may provide information but can also use persuasive techniques. Learners should distinguish facts, opinions and claims that need verification.

• Useful vocabulary: consumer, producer, product, service, price, quality, label, warranty, receipt, value and advertisement.

Suggested learning activity

Compare two product labels or advertisements. Identify factual information, persuasive language, price and safety information. Present a reasoned choice.

Check your understanding

1. Explain the role of a consumer.

2. Identify factors to consider before buying a product.

3. Distinguish factual claims from persuasive advertising.

4. Write a simple product comparison.

Relationships: Peers

Peer relationships are interactions among people of similar age or status. Positive relationships are based on respect, trust, cooperation and healthy boundaries.

Key knowledge and language

• Healthy communication involves listening, taking turns, expressing feelings appropriately and resolving disagreements calmly.

• Peer pressure may be positive or negative. Learners should practise decision-making, assertiveness and seeking help when a situation is unsafe.

• Respect differences in ability, background, opinions and interests. Avoid bullying, humiliation, exclusion and harmful online behaviour.

• Useful expressions: I understand your view; I see it differently because…; Could we agree to…?; I feel concerned when…

Suggested learning activity

Role-play a disagreement between friends. Practise active listening, polite disagreement, assertive refusal and a constructive solution.

Check your understanding

1. Describe features of positive peer relationships.

2. Identify positive and negative peer influence.

3. Use respectful expressions to resolve disagreement.

4. Write advice on maintaining healthy friendships.

Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation refers to support that helps a person recover skills, confidence, health or social participation after illness, injury, dependency or other difficulties.

Key knowledge and language

• Rehabilitation may involve health professionals, counsellors, family, teachers, community groups and support services.

• Effective communication avoids stigma. Use respectful, person-first language and focus on dignity, inclusion, safety and support.

• Texts about rehabilitation may present a problem, support process, challenges and outcomes. Learners can identify sequence, cause and effect, viewpoint and evidence.

• Useful vocabulary: recovery, counselling, support, inclusion, therapy, reintegration, resilience and community.

Suggested learning activity

Read an age-appropriate profile of a person who overcame a challenge with support. Identify the stages of the journey and discuss respectful ways a community can help.

Check your understanding

1. Explain rehabilitation in a suitable context.

2. Identify forms of support that promote recovery and inclusion.

3. Use respectful language when discussing people facing challenges.

4. Write a short supportive message or report.

Natural Resources: Wildlife

Wildlife refers to undomesticated plants and animals living in natural habitats. Wildlife forms part of biodiversity and contributes to ecological balance.

Key knowledge and language

• Habitats provide food, water, shelter and breeding spaces. Food chains and food webs show feeding relationships among organisms.

• Threats include habitat destruction, pollution, climate change, illegal hunting and human-wildlife conflict.

• Conservation measures include protected areas, habitat restoration, responsible tourism, law enforcement, research and community participation.

• Informational texts may include facts, descriptions, maps, diagrams and statistics. Learners should interpret captions and visual information.

Suggested learning activity

Study a wildlife information text, map or chart. Extract key facts about a species, its habitat, threats and conservation measures. Prepare a short fact file.

Check your understanding

1. Define wildlife and habitat.

2. Explain why wildlife conservation is important.

3. Identify threats to wildlife and suggest solutions.

4. Interpret information from a wildlife chart or map.

Tourism: Domestic

Domestic tourism involves people travelling within their own country for leisure, education, business or other purposes.

Key knowledge and language

• Tourist attractions may include national parks, beaches, mountains, cultural sites, museums and historical places.

• Tourism can support employment, businesses, infrastructure and cultural exchange. Poorly managed tourism may contribute to pollution, habitat disturbance and damage to heritage.

• Responsible visitors respect local cultures, follow site rules, avoid littering and support conservation.

• Language focus: descriptive vocabulary, directions, itinerary writing, recounts and giving information about places.

Suggested learning activity

Prepare a short itinerary for a domestic visit. Include destination, transport, activities, time sequence, safety and responsible visitor behaviour.

Check your understanding

1. Explain domestic tourism.

2. Identify different categories of tourist attractions in Kenya.

3. Describe benefits and possible challenges of tourism.

4. Write a clear travel itinerary or descriptive paragraph.

Heroes and Heroines: Africa

Heroes and heroines are people whose actions, leadership, creativity or service have made a significant contribution to their communities or countries.

Key knowledge and language

• Contributions may be in education, science, public service, sports, arts, environmental protection, human rights or community development.

• Biographical texts commonly include background, important events, challenges, achievements and legacy.

• Read biographies critically: distinguish verifiable facts from opinions, identify sources and avoid exaggeration.

• Useful language includes chronology markers: first, later, subsequently, during, eventually and in the end.

Suggested learning activity

Read a short biography of an African role model. Create a timeline of key events and deliver an oral account of the person's contribution.

Check your understanding

1. Explain what makes a person a role model.

2. Identify key features of a biography.

3. Sequence important events in a person's life.

4. Write a factual paragraph about an African hero or heroine.

Art

Art is a form of creative expression. It may communicate ideas, feelings, identity and experiences through visual, performing and literary forms.

Key knowledge and language

• Art forms include drawing, painting, sculpture, music, dance, drama, poetry and other creative expressions.

• Descriptions of artworks may refer to subject, materials, techniques, colour, line, shape, rhythm, mood and message.

• Appreciation involves observing carefully, describing evidence and expressing a reasoned response respectfully.

• Writing tasks may include reviews, descriptions, captions, short reports and reflective paragraphs.

Suggested learning activity

Observe an artwork or performance. Describe what is seen or heard, identify the message or mood and support an opinion with specific details.

Check your understanding

1. Identify different forms of art.

2. Describe features of an artwork or performance.

3. Express an opinion respectfully and support it with evidence.

4. Write a short descriptive or review paragraph.

Choosing a Career

Career choice is a process of exploring interests, abilities, values, opportunities and the requirements of different occupations.

Key knowledge and language

• Career information can be obtained from guidance teachers, family, mentors, institutions, employers and reliable publications.

• Career decisions may change as people gain experience and new opportunities emerge. Avoid assuming that a person's gender or background determines suitable work.

• Useful language includes occupation, qualification, skill, interest, aptitude, training, pathway, goal and opportunity.

• Writing tasks may include a personal profile, interview questions, a career plan and an informative paragraph.

Suggested learning activity

Interview a trusted adult about their work (with permission). Prepare questions about tasks, skills, training and challenges, then summarise what was learned.

Check your understanding

1. Explain factors that influence career choices.
2. Identify sources of reliable career information.
3. Prepare and conduct a simple interview.
4. Write a short personal career-interest statement.

Modern Fashion

Fashion includes clothing, accessories and styles that people use for practical, cultural and expressive purposes.

Key knowledge and language

• Fashion may be influenced by climate, culture, occupation, media, technology, affordability and personal preference.

• Responsible choices consider comfort, safety, suitability, quality, cost, durability and environmental impact.

• Media images may promote trends or unrealistic expectations. Learners should evaluate messages critically and respect individual differences.

• Language focus: descriptive adjectives, comparison, opinion statements, explanation and persuasive writing.

Suggested learning activity

Compare descriptions of two clothing styles for different settings. Discuss suitability, comfort, cost and cultural respect, then write a balanced opinion.

Check your understanding

1. Explain factors that influence fashion.
2. Describe clothing appropriately for different occasions.
3. Evaluate fashion choices using practical criteria.
4. Express an opinion respectfully in a discussion or paragraph.

Consumer Protection

Consumer protection refers to measures that promote fair treatment, product safety and access to accurate information when people buy goods or services.

Key knowledge and language

• Consumers should receive clear information and should not be misled by false claims, hidden charges or unsafe products.

• Useful practices include checking expiry dates, labels and instructions; keeping proof of purchase; and seeking help through appropriate channels when a product or service causes a problem.

• Consumer messages may use formal language, persuasive devices and evidence. Learners should identify purpose, audience and reliability.

• Writing tasks include complaint letters, notices, advice leaflets and short persuasive texts. Use courteous tone, clear facts and a specific request.

Suggested learning activity

Study a sample receipt and product label. Identify information that helps a consumer make a safe and informed choice. Draft a polite complaint about a fictional faulty product.

Check your understanding

1. Explain the purpose of consumer protection.

2. Identify information consumers should check before purchase.

3. Describe responsible steps when a product is faulty or unsafe.

4. Write a clear and courteous complaint.

Sports: Olympics

The Olympic Games are an international multi-sport event. Sport can promote fitness, teamwork, discipline, respect and peaceful interaction.

Key knowledge and language

• Olympic values are commonly expressed through excellence, respect and friendship. Fair play includes following rules, respecting officials and opponents, and accepting results responsibly.

• Sports reports often include who, what, when, where, why and how. They use action verbs, time markers, scores and quotations.

• Different sports have specific equipment, rules and safety requirements. Participation should be inclusive and appropriate to ability.

• Writing tasks may include a sports report, interview, commentary or event notice.

Suggested learning activity

Read a short sports report. Identify the event, participants, result and key details. Prepare a brief oral report using accurate information and respectful language.

Check your understanding

1. Explain values promoted through sport.

2. Identify key information in a sports report.

3. Use appropriate vocabulary to describe a sporting event.

4. Write a short factual sports report.

Tourist Attraction Sites: Africa

Africa has diverse natural and cultural attractions, including mountains, wildlife reserves, historic towns, archaeological sites, lakes, rivers and cultural landscapes.

Key knowledge and language

• Tourist sites may be valued for natural beauty, biodiversity, history, architecture, culture or scientific importance.

• Responsible tourism respects communities, protects heritage and wildlife, follows regulations and reduces environmental impact.

• Use reliable sources to verify site names, countries, features and conservation status. Maps, photographs, captions and travel texts provide different types of information.

• Writing tasks may include a travel feature, fact file, descriptive essay, poster or itinerary.

Suggested learning activity

Select an African attraction site. Use a map and reliable information text to identify its location, features and significance. Prepare a concise fact file and present it to peers.

Check your understanding

1. Identify categories of African tourist attractions.

2. Locate selected attraction sites using a map.

3. Explain why selected sites are significant.

4. Prepare a fact file or descriptive text about an African attraction.

Core English language skills across the year

Listening and Speaking

• Listen attentively for main ideas, specific details, attitude and purpose. Make brief notes where appropriate.

• Use turn-taking, eye contact appropriate to context, courteous expressions and relevant follow-up questions.

• Plan oral presentations with an introduction, organised points, supporting examples and a conclusion.

• Practise pronunciation, stress, intonation, pace and clear articulation.

Reading

• Use skimming to gain an overview and scanning to locate specific information.

• Read intensively to identify main ideas, supporting details, vocabulary in context, inference, tone and writer's purpose.

• Read extensively for information and enjoyment, selecting suitable fiction and non-fiction texts.

• Use reference materials such as dictionaries and thesauruses; record new vocabulary and use it accurately.

• Read poems and class-reader extracts for meaning, character, setting, sequence, style and lessons.

Grammar in Use

Compound nouns

Two or more words functioning together as one noun, e.g. school bus, swimming pool, mother-in-law. Plural formation varies: school buses, mothers-in-law.

Collective nouns

Nouns naming groups, e.g. team, audience, committee, flock and class. Choose singular or plural verb agreement according to meaning and usage.

Primary auxiliaries

Be, have and do. They help form tenses, questions, negatives and emphasis: She is reading; Have you finished?; Do not run.

Verbs and tenses

Verbs express actions, states or processes. Tense locates an event in time. Maintain consistent tense unless the meaning requires a change.

Adjectives

Words that describe or specify nouns, e.g. careful, bright, several. Use comparative and superlative forms accurately.

Adverbs

Words that modify verbs, adjectives or other adverbs, e.g. carefully, very, quite, yesterday. Place them where their meaning is clear.

Pronouns

Words used in place of nouns, e.g. personal, possessive, reflexive and demonstrative pronouns. Ensure the reference is clear.

Prepositions

Words showing relationships of place, time, direction or other relations, e.g. at, in, on, under, through and between.

Conjunctions

Words joining words, phrases or clauses, e.g. and, but, because, although and unless.

Determiners and quantifiers

Words placed before nouns to specify or quantify them, e.g. this, those, each, many, much, few and several.

Compound sentences

A compound sentence joins two or more independent clauses, often using coordinating conjunctions such as and, but or so.

Active and passive voice

In active voice, the subject performs the action. In passive voice, the subject receives the action; use the passive when the receiver or process is important.

Interrogative sentences

Questions require appropriate word order and punctuation. Practise yes/no questions, wh-questions and question tags as appropriate.

Writing

• Plan before writing: identify purpose, audience and form; brainstorm and organise ideas.

• Draft with a clear beginning, logically ordered paragraphs and an appropriate ending.

• Revise for meaning, organisation, coherence and suitable vocabulary. Edit grammar, spelling, punctuation and presentation.

• Use appropriate formats for friendly letters, narratives, dialogues, descriptions, notices, posters, lists and oral/written reports.

• Make notes by selecting key ideas and using headings or concise phrases. Summarise without changing the original meaning.

Writing formats: quick reference

Form	Essential features
Friendly letter	Writer's address and date; greeting; clear message in paragraphs; appropriate closing and name.
Narrative composition	Setting and characters; ordered events; conflict or development; resolution; consistent tense and point of view.
Dialogue	Speaker names or clear turns; new paragraph for a new speaker; appropriate punctuation and natural conversation.
Notice	Clear heading; event or information; date, time, venue and audience where relevant; contact or action required.
Poster	Short memorable heading; concise message; readable layout; relevant image or visual; essential details.
Oral report	Topic or event; key facts in logical order; clear voice; accurate details; concise conclusion.
Summary	Main points only; concise wording; logical order; no unnecessary examples or personal opinions.

End-of-year revision tasks

• Deliver a short oral presentation on a scientific innovation and answer follow-up questions.

• Read a passage about wildlife conservation and identify the main idea, supporting details, vocabulary and writer's purpose.

• Write a narrative paragraph about a positive peer relationship, using accurate tense and paragraphing.

• Identify compound nouns, collective nouns, auxiliaries, adjectives, adverbs, pronouns, prepositions and conjunctions in a selected text.

• Transform selected active sentences into passive voice and explain how the emphasis changes.

• Prepare a friendly letter, a dialogue, a notice and a poster for suitable audiences and purposes.

• Read a selected poem and explain its message, mood and selected language features.

• Prepare a fact file about an African tourist attraction using verified information and a map.

Teacher's note: Use current KICD curriculum guidance to confirm the exact lesson-level scope and approved class-reader selection. Provide inclusive opportunities for learners to communicate, read widely, practise language and produce original work.